are needed. Based on this analysis, the PEP sends an attribute query to her wallet asking for two types of claims: her employer and her CISA-R certification status. Angela's wallet replies by assembling a presentation that includes the necessary claims from two different credentials: her employment credential from AuditsRUs and her certification credential from NISA. Cryptography ensures each claim remains bound to its original issuer and confirms both credentials were issued to Angela's wallet. From ACME's point of view, it receives a single presentation with the attributes required to assess the relevant policies.

Requesting specific attributes rather than credentials offers additional benefits. It keeps ACME from depending on issuer-specific credential formats. It allows ACME to evolve its policies without coordinating changes with external organizations. It also protects holders by minimizing unnecessary disclosure. The wallet discloses only the claims required, even if the underlying credentials contain more information.

This presentation model is essential for supporting ACME's wider product ecosystem. Different workflows require various attributes. A clinic workflow may request professional affiliation and licensing information. A supplier portal might ask for employment and delegation information. A system for managing field technicians could request role assignments and scope-of-work details. In each instance, the verifier requests the attributes it needs, and the holder assembles an appropriate presentation from whatever credentials they have.

Together, these mechanisms provide ACME with a flexible, privacy-respecting way to gather the contextual information it needs without taking responsibility for issuing, storing, or interpreting raw identity data. ACME has outsourced those tasks to organizations better equipped to handle them.

16.6 Using verifiable credentials with policies

Once the PEP verifies a credential presentation and extracts the relevant claims, those claims become part of the context that the PDP uses during policy evaluation. The policy engine doesn't see the presentation itself; it only sees the structured attributes that ACME has chosen to model, such as